

setup of hypervisors, infrastructure, et al, which will help you migrate from one to another, seamlessly.

Q So, software defined data centres could replace traditional data centres in the future? Therefore, can we consider them a part of new-age IT?

Well, I don't believe that is so. We have been living with old TP for about 30-35 years. As the cloud, big data and mobility pick up even more, and are used in the context of analytics, you will still have two contexts residing together, which is old TP and old AP. Then you would have more converged systems and will talk about converged system management. That is exactly our version of how we want to define software defined data centres.

Q We talk a lot about integrated and converged systems. It sounds like a great idea as it would involve all the solutions coming in from one vendor. But does that not lead to some kind of vendor lock-in?

No it doesn't, primarily because these are workload specific. So, one would not implement a converged system just for the sake of it. As I mentioned, it has to be workload specific. So, if you want to virtualise, then you would do one type of converged system or integrated system. If you want to do Hanna, that is an entirely different converged system. What helps the customers is that it breaks down the cycle of project deployment and hence, frees up a lot of resources that would otherwise be consumed for more active deployment or transitioning from one context to another.

Q So, are SMBs ready to jump onto the integrated systems' bandwagon?

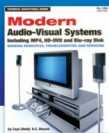
Yes, there are quite a few SMBs in India that are very positive about integrated systems. Customers, irrespective of the segment that they belong to, look at it from the angle of how the business functions, and what kind of specificity they want to get to. I wouldn't be particularly concerned about the segment, but I would look at it from the context of what workload specificity a customer wants.

Q What are the issues that you have seen IT heads face while adopting converged IT systems?

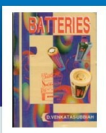
Fortunately, we have not heard of many challenges that the IT heads have faced while adopting converged IT solutions. In fact, it has eased things for them, primarily because they have been told in advance about what they are getting into. They are no more dealing with three separate items. They are getting into one whole thing, which is getting deployed and what they used to take months to achieve, is done in two or three days. This is because we run the app maps prior to the actual sale and tell them what exactly will reach them, how it will run and what kind of performance it will deliver. The major challenges are related to the fact that they are on the verge of a transition (from the business perspective), and they see any transition as being slightly risky. Hence, they thoroughly check on the ROI and are generally very cautious. **END**

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